Rewriting Workbook

MCCJ 525 – Assessing Security Features of Online Platforms

How to use this workbook

- Work one section at a time. **Read** the facts and questions, **close** the original paper, then **write** in the green box as if explaining to a classmate.
- Use **first person** ("I checked…", "In my view…"). The assignment asks about platforms **you** use, so your own experience is the strongest content.
- Keep every **citation** in brackets, e.g. (Dhaka Tribune, 2024). You may change the wording around it freely.
- Short, simple sentences are fine. Your natural voice is better than polished-sounding phrasing.
- Afterwards, copy your sections into the Word template (Times New Roman 12, 1.5 spacing), add screenshots, and check the total is **under 1,500 words**.
- Grammarly: spelling and grammar fixes only. Do not use "Rephrase", "Improve it" or other rewrite features.
- Turn on **Track Changes / version history** while writing, as evidence that the work is yours.

1. Introduction

Word budget: ≈200 words **Purpose:** Explain why account security matters in Bangladesh and how you did the assessment.

Facts and sources you can use (keep the citation)

- ≈64 million Bangladeshis use Facebook (Statista, 2025)
- CCAF 2024 study: social media / online account hacking was the most common cybercrime, 21.65% of victims (Dhaka Tribune, 2024)
- ≈59% of victims were women; 78.78% aged 18–30; only 12% reported to police (Dhaka Tribune, 2024)
- Your 5 platforms: Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, Gmail, Telegram
- Method: checked settings on your phone + official help pages + news; scored 1–5 on 5 criteria (login protection, encryption by default, alerts, recovery safety, privacy controls)

Questions to answer in your own words

- Why did you choose these five apps? How often do you use them?
- Which ONE statistic surprised you most, and why?
- What exactly did you do: which phone, which menus, roughly how long?
- Why compare with a 1–5 score instead of just describing them?

Add something only you can add

- Have you, a friend or relative ever had an account hacked or received a phishing message? One sentence about it makes a strong opening.

Write your version here (close the original first):

2.1 Facebook

Word budget: ≈110 words **Purpose:** Describe the security features you found.

Facts and sources you can use (keep the citation)

- Path: Accounts Center → Password and security
- 2FA: authenticator app, SMS code or physical security key
- Login alerts; "Where you're logged in" remote log-out; Security Checkup
- Passkeys since June 2025, extended to Messenger Sept 2025 (Meta, 2025)
- Profile lock (popular in Bangladesh)
- Messenger personal chats end-to-end encrypted by default since Dec 2023 (Crisan, 2023)
- Weak point: account recovery is slow and automated once a hacker changes email/phone

Questions to answer in your own words

- Which of these did YOU already have turned on? Which did you switch on during this assignment?
- Which feature do you think helps Bangladeshi users most, and why?

Add something only you can add

- Screenshot: Facebook → Accounts Center → Password and security (Figure 1)

Write your version here (close the original first):

2.2 Instagram

Word budget: ≈100 words **Purpose:** Describe the security features you found.

Facts and sources you can use (keep the citation)

- Shares Meta Accounts Center: same 2FA, login alerts, login activity
- "Emails from Instagram": shows genuine security emails from the last 14 days (helps spot phishing)
- Restrict, Hidden Words, message-request limits; Teen Accounts private by default
- DMs are NOT end-to-end encrypted; Meta removed the optional encrypted chats on 8 May 2026 (Euronews, 2026)

Questions to answer in your own words

- Did you know about "Emails from Instagram" before? Did you try it?
- Why does unencrypted DMs matter, especially for young women (sextortion, image abuse)?

Add something only you can add

- Screenshot: Instagram → Settings → Accounts Center → Password and security (Figure 2)

Write your version here (close the original first):

2.3 WhatsApp

Word budget: ≈110 words **Purpose:** Describe the security features you found.

Facts and sources you can use (keep the citation)

- All personal chats/calls/status end-to-end encrypted by default
- Six-digit two-step verification PIN; passkey login
- Passkey-protected encrypted backups since Oct 2025 (Help Net Security, 2025)
- Chat lock, "Silence unknown callers", IP protection in calls
- Strict Account Settings (Jan 2026): one-tap lockdown (WhatsApp, 2026)
- Weakness: phone number = identity; code-sharing scams ("I sent my code to you by mistake…")

Questions to answer in your own words

- Did you have a two-step PIN before this assignment?
- Have you seen the code-sharing scam message in Bangladesh? How does it work?

Add something only you can add

- Screenshot: WhatsApp → Settings → Account → Two-step verification / Privacy → Advanced (Figure 3)

Write your version here (close the original first):

2.4 Gmail

Word budget: ≈110 words **Purpose:** Describe the security features you found.

Facts and sources you can use (keep the citation)

- Passkeys default sign-in for personal Google accounts since Oct 2023 (Google, 2023)
- 2-Step Verification, Security Checkup, critical security alerts, recent activity list
- Advanced Protection Program for high-risk users
- Google says >99.9% of phishing and malware attempts blocked (Engadget, 2025)
- Confidential mode (expiry, no forwarding)
- Limitation: personal Gmail not end-to-end encrypted

Questions to answer in your own words

- Why is email the "master key" for all other accounts?
- Did Security Checkup show you anything to fix?

Add something only you can add

- Screenshot: Google Account → Security → How you sign in to Google (Figure 4)

Write your version here (close the original first):

2.5 Telegram

Word budget: ≈110 words **Purpose:** Describe the security features you found.

Facts and sources you can use (keep the citation)

- Two-step verification (cloud password); passcode lock; Active sessions list
- Hide phone number completely; connect by username
- Secret Chats are end-to-end encrypted, device-specific, self-destruct timers
- Ordinary chats, groups and channels are NOT end-to-end encrypted (stored on servers)
- Sept 2024: Telegram said it will share IPs and phone numbers of rule-breakers on valid legal requests (Engadget, 2024)

Questions to answer in your own words

- Did you think Telegram was the most private app before? What changed your mind?
- Have you ever started a Secret Chat?

Add something only you can add

- Screenshot: Telegram → Settings → Privacy and Security (Figure 5)

Write your version here (close the original first):

3. Additional features each platform should add

Word budget: ≈250 words (can keep a table) **Purpose:** Answer Question II: what should be added and WHY.

Facts and sources you can use (keep the citation)

- Facebook: 48-hour cool-down before new email/phone/2FA changes take effect + alerts to old contacts; Bangla human support
- Instagram: restore E2EE DMs as default; blur unsolicited explicit images for all users
- WhatsApp: Bangla warning screen when a registration code is requested; mandatory 2-step PIN
- Gmail: optional E2EE for personal accounts; lookalike-domain warnings for bKash, Nagad, local banks
- Telegram: E2EE by default for 1-to-1 chats; 2-step prompt at sign-up; warnings on scam "job/investment" channels

Questions to answer in your own words

- For each app, which gap did you personally notice? Your own idea can replace one of these.
- Why is "secure by default" better than optional settings? Think about how many friends have opened these menus.

Add something only you can add

- Feel free to propose one feature that is completely your own idea.

Write your version here (close the original first):

4. Which platform is most secure?

Word budget: ≈250 words + scorecard table **Purpose:** Answer Question III with your judgement and comments.

Facts and sources you can use (keep the citation)

- Scores (out of 25): WhatsApp 20, Gmail 20, Facebook 16, Instagram 16, Telegram 14
- Tie-breaker argument: WhatsApp's strongest protection works by default, no setup needed
- Gmail: best login protection and filters; the "master key" to other accounts
- Telegram lowest: reputation stronger than its defaults
- No platform protects a user who shares an OTP or reuses a weak password

Questions to answer in your own words

- Do you agree with these scores? Change any you disagree with; it is your assessment.
- Which app would YOU now recommend to a younger sibling, and why?

Add something only you can add

- Mention any setting you switched on because of this assignment.

Write your version here (close the original first):

5. Conclusion

Word budget: ≈90 words **Purpose:** Summarise and reflect.

Facts and sources you can use (keep the citation)

- All five have serious security tools, but defaults differ
- WhatsApp leads for private communication; Gmail for account protection
- Platforms should make strong settings default and speak Bangla; users should spend 5 minutes enabling protections

Questions to answer in your own words

- What is the one lesson you personally take away?

Add something only you can add

- End with your own opinion in one or two sentences.

Write your version here (close the original first):

References (APA 7) – keep only the ones you cite

- Crisan, L. (2023, December 6). Launching default end-to-end encryption on Messenger. Meta Newsroom.
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- Meta. (2025, June 18). Introducing passkeys on Facebook for an easier sign-in. Meta Newsroom.
- Statista. (2025). Countries with the most Facebook users as of October 2025.
- WhatsApp. (2026, January 27). WhatsApp's latest privacy protection: Strict account settings. WhatsApp Blog.

Full URLs are in the original paper's reference list.